READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27-40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

Who looks after the children in today's Britain?

A When Simon Baron-Cohen recently published a book, *The Essential Difference*, in which he claimed that the female brain is predominantly hard-wired for empathy, the male brain is predominantly hard-wired for understanding and building systems, he caught the mood of the moment. His team's experiments on day-old babies, and the finding that the male babies looked for longer at a hanging toy and the female babies longer at a face, has been repeatedly cited in the press since his book's publication. However, Elizabeth Spelke is one expert who is sceptical about whether this experiment deserves such attention. This is one isolated experiment, she says. 'Its findings fly in the face of dozens of studies on similar aspects of cognition carried out on young babies over decades. It is astonishing how much this one study has been cited, when the many studies that show no difference between the sexes, or a difference in the other direction, are ignored.'

B One of Baron-Cohen's other main studies was conducted by collecting and examining responses to questionnaires completed by adults on their own behaviour: the sort of quiz well known to readers of magazines. The answers recorded in such cases will reflect differences formed by cultural assumptions and socialisation: it is hard to see what they tell us about innate differences. Nevertheless, they have become a fashionable reference point, and recently Princess Anne, patron of Women into Science and Engineering, gave a speech in which she quoted Baron-Cohen's research as proof that six out of ten men have a systemising brain. This kind of science has passed into everyday culture, often outrunning the intentions of those who did the original work.

C Social expectations play heavily with young men and women, and expectations are in some ways more conventional in Britain today than they were ten or 20 years ago. It is particularly when they have children that women find out how society reinforces traditional expectations of their behaviour. They discover that many pressures - including the work schedule of their male partner and the expectations of his employer that it should be maintained - make it hard to combine work and home without giving their paid work a lower priority than their male colleagues do. In such a context, the claims about males' greater power to systemise and compete only serve to put further pressure on women.

D The pressures are equally powerful on men to continue in a traditional lifestyle. Some educationalists argue that among young men the concern that they might appear 'feminine' is higher than ever and may even hold back educational achievement, since studying is often seen as girlish. In later life, the drive to competitiveness in the workplace is mythologised as being tied to high levels of masculinity. Men are also told that high achievers attract more women, even though evidence shows that as women slowly become more equal at work, they begin to care less about the economic status of potential partners.

E Men are often held back from making the choice to move deeper into domestic life, and in particular childcare, feeling that it lacks status. While the gains in making a social revolution were clear for women - they could gain status and income by moving beyond the home - the gains in the parallel social revolution are harder for men to see, since it will involve them in losing status and income. The idea that men are naturally less empathetic also produces feelings of fatalism about their role. Yet there is much evidence to show that even being empathetic and good at parenting is a learned behaviour.

F It is true that, as the linguist Steven Pinker noted, in our culture women respond more readily to their children's cries, but there is nothing to say that this is down to anything other than practice and socialisation. In a culture where most men return to work straight after the birth of their children, it would be extraordinary if they did manage to remain as alert to their needs as women who remain at home. In one test carried out with teenagers, although girls said that they liked children more than boys said they did, when left alone with a crying infant, their responses were no different. Women can testify to the fact that parenting is a tricky, complicated process, not always a natural, easy role.

G However, while the definite trend of a decade ago is no longer evident, the movement towards equality has not completely stalled. A more equal sharing of childcare and even domestic labour is still desired by many men as well as women. Nearly three-quarters of young British men say that if it were financially possible they would like to stay at home to look after their families. And three-quarters of young men tell pollsters that the amount of time fathers are allowed to take off work after a birth - paternity leave - is too short in Britain. The government is therefore proposing more equal policies on maternity/paternity leave, knowing that the pressure is still forwards rather than backwards. And remember that in Britain, young men in full-time work spend about an hour a day looking after their children. That may sound paltry, but not compared to the 15 minutes they spent 30 years ago: if the time went on increasing fourfold every 30 years, equal partnership would become a reality for their grandchildren.

Questions 27–33

Which paragraph contains the following information?

*Write the correct letter, **A–G**, in boxes 27–33 on your answer sheet.*

NB *You may use any letter more than once.*

27 a possible argument for poor academic performance in young boys

28 a comparison between fathers' and mothers' reactions to babies' demands

29 a reference to a change in women's interest in men's earning power

30 a reference to a study on infant behaviour

31 a prediction that there will be more involvement of men in childcare

32 a reference to analysis using a popular self-assessment method

33 results of an experiment on adolescents' reactions to young babies

Questions 34–36

*Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** or **D**.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 34–36 on your answer sheet.

34 What is Elizabeth Spelke's reaction to Baron-Cohen's experiment?

A She is surprised that other studies do not agree with its findings.
B She is confident that other research will be done in this area.
C She is doubtful whether it merits the notice it has been given.
D She is disappointed that it focused on such young infants.

35 According to the writer, why do mothers often put childcare above career demands?

A Few allowances are made for fathers to reduce their working hours.
B Their bosses are not keen to employ them for full-time work.
C They find that the competitive workplace loses its attraction.
D The social benefit system encourages them to stay at home.

36 What does the writer suggest about women as parents in paragraph F?

A They are naturally well suited to looking after children.
B They have to work at mastering the skills of motherhood.
C Their hearing is naturally attuned so they can respond to babies.
D Their natural desire is to stay at home to care for children.

Questions 37–40

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 37–40 on your answer sheet.

Men and childcare

One reason why some men may be unwilling to leave their jobs to look after their children is because the gains that could come with such a change are not obvious. Staying at home would in fact mean accepting a considerable drop in pay and in **37** _____. The conventional notion that men are not as **38** _____ as women may also lead men to experience a certain sense of resignation about their traditional place in society. However, it is interesting to note that the majority of young men in the UK say that the statutory time permitted for **39** _____ is inadequate. Influence is thus being exerted on the **40** _____ to review the existing provision.

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Questions 27–33 段落信息匹配题

题号	答案	题干翻译	定位	定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
27	D	年轻男孩学业表现差的一个可能解释	D段中部	Some educationalists argue that among young men the concern that they might appear 'feminine' is higher than ever and may even hold back educational achievement, since studying is often seen as girlish.	一些教育家认为，在年轻男性中，担心自己显得"女性化"的程度比以往任何时候都更高，这甚至可能阻碍他们的学业成就，因为学习常常被看作是"女孩子气"的事情。	题干中的 **poor academic performance** 对应原文 **hold back educational achievement**，即阻碍学业成就。**a possible argument** 对应 **Some educationalists argue**。所以答案是 D。
28	F	父亲和母亲对婴儿需求反应的比较	F段前半部分	Women respond more readily to their children's cries, but there is nothing to say that this is down to anything other than practice and socialisation. In a culture where most men return to work straight after the birth of their children, it would be extraordinary if they did manage to remain as alert to their needs as women who remain at home.	女性对孩子哭声的反应更快，但没有证据说明这不是由练习和社会化造成的。在一种大多数男性在孩子出生后马上回去工作的文化中，如果他们还能像留在家中的女性一样对孩子的需求保持敏感，那反而会很不寻常。	题干的 **fathers' and mothers' reactions** 对应原文中 **men return to work** 与 **women who remain at home** 的比较；**babies' demands** 对应 **children's cries / their needs**。该段比较了男女对孩子需求的敏感度，所以答案是 F。
29	D	提到女性对男性赚钱能力的兴趣发生变化	D段后半部分	Men are also told that high achievers attract more women, even though evidence shows that as women slowly become more equal at work, they begin to care less about the economic status of potential partners.	男性也被告知，高成就者会吸引更多女性，尽管证据显示，随着女性在工作中逐渐变得更加平等，她们开始不那么在意潜在伴侣的经济地位。	题干中的 **men's earning power** 对应原文 **the economic status of potential partners**；**a change in women's interest** 对应 **begin to care less**。女性越来越不在意男性经济地位，这是兴趣变化。答案是 D。
30	A	提到一项关于婴儿行为的研究	A段前半部分	His team's experiments on day-old babies, and the finding that the male babies looked for longer at a hanging toy and the female babies longer at a face, has been repeatedly cited in the press.	他的团队对出生一天的婴儿进行了实验，发现男婴看悬挂玩具的时间更长，而女婴看人脸的时间更长，这一发现被媒体反复引用。	**infant behaviour** 对应 **day-old babies looked for longer...**，这是婴儿的观察行为。注意本题问的是"婴儿行为研究"，不是青少年对婴儿的反应，所以不是 F，而是 A。
31	G	预测男性会更多参与育儿	G段结尾	If the time went on increasing fourfold every 30 years, equal partnership would become a reality for their grandchildren.	如果这个时间继续每 30 年增加四倍，那么平等的育儿伙伴关系将在他们孙辈一代成为现实。	原文先说男性现在每天照顾孩子约一小时，30 年前只有 15 分钟；然后预测如果继续增长，未来会实现平等分担。题干中的 **prediction** 对应 **would become a reality**，答案是 G。
32	B	提到使用一种流行的自我评估方法进行分析	B段开头	One of Baron-Cohen's other main studies was conducted by collecting and examining responses to questionnaires completed by adults on their own behaviour: the sort of quiz well known to readers of magazines.	Baron-Cohen 的另一项主要研究，是通过收集并分析成年人对自己行为问卷的回答来进行的：这种测验是杂志读者很熟悉的那类小测验。	**analysis** 对应 **collecting and examining responses**；**self-assessment method** 对应 **questionnaires completed by adults on their own behaviour**；**popular** 对应 **well known to readers of magazines**。答案是 B。
33	F	青少年对年幼婴儿反应实验的结果	F段后半部分	In one test carried out with teenagers, although girls said that they liked children more than boys said they did, when left alone with a crying infant, their responses were no different.	在一项针对青少年的测试中，虽然女孩表示她们比男孩更喜欢孩子，但当她们被单独留下来面对一个哭泣的婴儿时，她们的反应并没有不同。	**adolescents** 对应 **teenagers**；**young babies** 对应 **a crying infant**；**results** 对应 **their responses were no different**。答案是 F。

Questions 34–36 选择题

题号	答案	题干翻译	选项翻译	定位句与翻译	详细解释
34	C	Elizabeth Spelke 对 Baron-Cohen 的实验有什么反应？	A 她惊讶于其他研究不认同该实验的发现。B 她相信这个领域还会有更多研究。C 她怀疑该实验是否值得它所获得的关注。D 她失望于该实验研究的是这么小的婴儿。	A段：However, Elizabeth Spelke is one expert who is skeptical about whether this experiment deserves such attention. This is one isolated experiment, she says... It is astonishing how much this one study has been cited...然而，Elizabeth Spelke 是一位怀疑该实验是否值得如此关注的专家。她说，这只是一个孤立的实验……令人惊讶的是，这一项研究竟然被引用了这么多次。	核心对应是 **skeptical about whether this experiment deserves such attention** = **doubtful whether it merits the notice it has been given**。所以选 C。A 错在她不是"惊讶其他研究不同意"，而是惊讶这一个实验被过度引用。B 没有提到。D 错在她不是失望于婴儿年龄小，而是质疑该实验的代表性和受关注程度。
35	A	根据作者，为什么母亲常常把育儿放在事业需求之上？	A 很少有安排允许父亲减少工作时间。B 她们的老板不愿意雇佣她们做全职工作。C 她们发现竞争激烈的职场失去了吸引力。D 社会福利制度鼓励她们留在家中。	C段：They discover that many pressures — including the work schedule of their male partner and the expectations of his employer that it should be maintained — make it hard to combine work and home without giving their paid work a lower priority than their male colleagues do.她们发现许多压力——包括男性伴侣的工作时间安排，以及其雇主希望这一安排保持不变的期待——使她们很难兼顾工作和家庭，除非她们比男性同事更低地看待自己的有偿工作。	题干中的 **put childcare above career demands** 对应原文 **giving their paid work a lower priority**。原因是男性伴侣的工作安排被期待维持不变，也就是父亲一方很少被允许或被期待减少工作时间，所以母亲更容易被迫让事业让位于家庭。这里 A 中的 **allowances** 不是"津贴"，而是"通融、弹性安排"。B 说母亲老板不愿雇佣她们，原文没有说。C 说职场失去吸引力，原文没有说她们主观上不想工作。D 社会福利制度完全未提及。
36	B	作者在 F 段暗示女性作为父母是什么情况？	A 她们天生很适合照顾孩子。B 她们必须努力掌握母亲身份所需的技能。C 她们的听觉天生调适得好，所以能回应婴儿。D 她们的天然愿望是留在家照顾孩子。	F段：Women respond more readily to their children's cries, but there is nothing to say that this is down to anything other than practice and socialisation... Women can testify to the fact that parenting is a tricky, complicated process, not always a natural, easy role.女性对孩子哭声反应更快，但没有证据说明这不是由练习和社会化造成的……女性可以证明，育儿是一个棘手而复杂的过程，并不总是一个自然、轻松的角色。	原文明确否定"女性天生就会育儿"的观点，强调她们的反应更多来自 **practice and socialisation**，即练习和社会化；并且说 parenting 不是 natural, easy role。B 的 **have to work at mastering the skills** 正好概括了"育儿需要学习和练习"。A、C、D 都带有"天生"的意思，与原文相反。

Questions 37–40 摘要填空题

题号	答案	题干翻译	定位	定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
37	status	待在家照顾孩子事实上意味着接受收入和____的大幅下降。	E段中部	The gains in the parallel social revolution are harder for men to see, since it will involve them in losing status and income.	对男性来说，这场平行的社会革命所带来的好处更难看到，因为它会让他们失去地位和收入。	题干中的 **drop in pay** 对应原文 **losing income**；空格与 pay 并列，原文另一个损失是 **status**。所以填 **status**。
38	empathetic	男性不像女性那样____的传统观念，也可能让男性对自己的传统社会角色产生某种认命感。	E段后半部分	The idea that men are naturally less empathetic also produces feelings of fatalism about their role.	男性天生共情能力较弱的观念，也会使他们对自己的角色产生宿命感。	**not as 38 as women** 对应 **naturally less empathetic**；**sense of resignation** 对应 **feelings of fatalism**。所以填 **empathetic**。
39	paternity leave	英国大多数年轻男性认为，法律允许的____时间是不足的。	G段中部	Three-quarters of young men tell pollsters that the amount of time fathers are allowed to take off work after a birth — paternity leave — is too short in Britain.	四分之三的年轻男性告诉民意调查者，英国父亲在孩子出生后被允许休假的时间——陪产假——太短。	**statutory time permitted** 对应 **the amount of time fathers are allowed to take off work**；**inadequate** 对应 **too short**。空格要填具体制度，即 **paternity leave**。
40	government	因此，影响/压力正施加在____身上，促使其重新审视现有规定。	G段中后部	The government is therefore proposing more equal policies on maternity/paternity leave, knowing that the pressure is still forwards rather than backwards.	因此，政府正在提出更加平等的产假/陪产假政策，因为它知道这种压力仍然是向前推进的，而不是倒退的。	题干中的 **Influence is thus being exerted on…** 对应原文 **the pressure is still forwards**；能够 **review the existing provision** 的主体是 **government**，原文也明确说政府正在提出新政策。所以填 **government**。